

A portfolio talks about 1: multiple exploitations: child labor, gender stereotypes in work, modern slavery, and pornography. 2: potential social improvements

Power and Value portfolio: Exploitation and social improvement

This portfolio will cover exploitation, an issue that comes up regularly in this module, and then go on to a section on social progress. People from different backgrounds are impacted by exploitation, which takes many different forms. In this portfolio, the issue of child labor and its root cause—the poverty trap—are examined. After that, the issue of modern slavery as it relates to immigrants is explored, and then the negative effects of pornography are covered. Additionally, the suffering brought on by gender stereotypes' exploitation of women is also covered. However, this portfolio also covers several social improvement plans in addition to issues with exploitation. Protests, CSR (corporate social responsibility), and economic analysis are various ways that social progress can be made. I will evaluate the perspectives presented in lectures, and give my own opinion about these topics, which will be justified.

Exploitation is a frequent subject and topic in this module. That anybody, including children, women, and low-wage workers, could be the target of exploitation. A common problem brought on by the poverty trap is child labor. The youngsters are forced to work since some families may not be able to afford school. Due to a lack of education and skills, they might earn a relatively low salary for the rest of their lives. However, because of their low income, their children are once more receiving inadequate education, which brings the cycle full circle. Government action and international financial assistance are two ways to address this issue, which aim to improve school quality and reduce the cost burden on parents. While there is potential for physical and facility improvement, I believe that child exploitation continues. This is because family, which is widely recognized and acknowledged, has an even greater impact on mental and cognitive growth than schools. (Servaas et al., 2011) . Their parents might favor employment over schooling for their young children. The most frequent explanation is that parents worry more about the immediate interests (the money or benefits provided to the family now) than the long-term benefits due to the high time expenses. If parents' and families' viewpoints could shift, child labor exploitation may be better addressed. Otherwise, it would be hard.

In lecture 3, a report from the Indian Labour Force Survey shows that males between the ages of 15 and 17 had a high labor participation rate. For girls in

the same age range, the rate is likewise high when full-time housework is taken into account. However, housework is a form of exploitation that affects all women, not just young girls. In lecture 8, which is about domestic labor, this issue is covered. Despite progress in gender equality, women continue to do the majority of household chores. The statistics of unpaid work from I-PEEL (International political economy of everyday life) use pounds to reflect the value of housework (Arat-koç, no date), which reveals the truth that wages are commonly not paid to women. Nevertheless, in my opinion, it can be deduced that the harm caused by exploitation is not just limited to unpaid labor. Many accomplished women give up their careers to care for their families and undertake comparatively low-paid housework jobs. A well-educated lady might leave her job at the corporation, for instance, to work babysitting. Because of the unfair gender stereotype, women are frequently exploited in this sacrifice for the family or, to be more precise, for "social reproduction."

One definition of social reproduction given by a video is a social power that produces labor as a commodity (Bhattacharya, 2017). It also gives an example that social reproduction is a procedure that happens when laborers are not at work. For instance, a bed for sleep is a social reproduction, for it helps laborers in preparing for the next day's work. Also, it involves the production of the next working class, which includes biological reproduction, which may occur directly through childbirth. Educational reproduction, which improves the skills of the next generation of workers, is another aspect of social reproduction. These works can be gendered at times, which leads some feminist lawmakers to believe that women may be exploited. However, the reason why these works are gendered could be simply stereotyping though, a concept of family strategy' might explain, which is mainly about maximizing the family resources through every family member (Laslett and Brenner, 1989). A family needs to decide who will work domestically and who will work outside, for attaining resources more sufficiently. I believe this decision might be influenced by the comparative advantage theory. For instance, consider the traditional family that James, Ada, and their young children have built. Ada does not necessarily need to work at home even though she makes a little less than James if James is considerably better at housework than Ada. Since James works at home and Ada works outside, the family's efficiency is maximized, which is consistent with the comparative advantage principle. Gender discrimination, however, happens when Ada still works at home in the given case, for this outcome sacrifices the efficiency of attaining resources because of the gender stereotype. Even though James is better at both making money outside and working domestically, my opinion is that the social reproduction tasks ought to be governed by opportunity cost theory rather than gender.

However, childbirth is not the only way to increase the working labor population, immigration and slavery are 2 other ways to increase the working

population. Modern slavery involves making people do things they would otherwise not do such as forced labor, sex exploitation, etc. This type of slavery could be called ‘modern slavery’, which happens more frequently to vulnerable people like immigrants. In lecture 6, many examples of modern slavery are about immigrants: unlike child labor and exploitation of women, immigrants are forced to work because they are deprived of personal liberty. For instance, their employer may illegally detain them and keep their passports in order to force them to do work for free, which occasionally involves using physical force and intimidation. For instance, some immigrants may have come from human trafficking, and are forced to work in illegal gambling and telecom fraud in the Golden Triangle, a special economic zone where the borders of Thailand, Laos, and Myanmar meet. Some women are compelled to perform sex acts. For instance, since 2007, the Lao authorities have rescued 1680 victims from various nations in the Golden Triangle region. Additionally, the majority of victims are foreigners, who may be imprisoned in tiny structures and spaces. Despite some of them being promised lacerated jobs before they arrive, they are basically working in service sectors that are low-paid (Gerin, 2022). This example of modern slavery shows the harm it brings to society and individuals, for it is an exploitation of freedom.

Nevertheless, sex exploitation is also a part of modern slavery, which mostly impacts women. However, it may not be limited in reality. The exploitation could be a message sent by ‘unhealthy pornography’. The concept of pornography is discussed in lecture 7 with FSD (free speech defense), which also mentions the harm might because it subordinates women. This concept is expanded upon by saying that one of the main reasons pornography is bad is because it frequently depicts males dominating women rather than, as is occasionally the case, a healthy relationship between men and women (Gavrieli, 2013). There are several reasons for the unfavorable perception of pornographic materials, including but not limited to erotic movies and images. These reasons include the potential for mental illness, the potential harm to children, and other issues. The difference between pornography and erotic, however, is that the former objectifies women, which sometimes sends the message that using women as a means of catharsis. In most pornographic materials, a healthy relationship between men and women is not portrayed. As an illustration, many pornographic videos emphasize penetration, and some of them assault women sexually and violently to demonstrate the dominance of men in sex. The main harm of pornography is, therefore, the message it sends to society, which may result in incorrect perceptions of sex, especially for teenagers who receive little sex education.

The module's discussion of power mostly focuses on the unequal allocation of power among individuals and exposes various forms of exploitation, but this module also offers some suggestions for how to make political and economic

progress in society. Protest is a topic that is taught in the 1st lecture along with other social movements. The study of protest represents the popular opinion and is a crucial illustration of democracy, which ensures that citizens have the ability to exercise political power. Child labor, gender discrimination, and other issues related to exploitation might all be reflected in protests and other social movements, and some of these issues could even be addressed. However, some demonstrations could occasionally challenge monopolistic issues. The monopoly dilemma, profit-seeking problem, and the rise of consumerism in culture are a few general themes that were covered in lecture 2. It is important to note that some businesses now outperform some government organizations in terms of revenue. Walmart's revenue in 2015 ranked 10th among all organizations and was larger than the Spanish government (Sweet, 2016), indicating a potential monopoly issue. To restrict the potential harm that private businesses can do to society, anti-monopoly laws and corporate social responsibility are adopted. According to traditional economic theory, the majority of private companies only consider shareholder returns when making decisions. The corporate social responsibility hypothesis, on the other hand, encourages private businesses to take into account the total societal benefits, which include a number of stakeholders (workers, consumers, the government...). But the fact that corporate social responsibility (CSR) is a vague concept, in my opinion, makes it less trustworthy than law enforcement. For example, vegetable production in the UK has a complete CSR system in place to combat the country's heavily concentrated retailing industry. Some supermarkets have been criticized for overcharging British farmers and breaking past agreements. However, when facing these criticisms, instead of treating native farmers better, these supermarkets move to hire cheaper foreign labor as substitutes (New, 2015). By doing this, supermarkets are free from criticism by CSR-related organizations, but the situation of UK farmers are not improved

In lectures 9 and 10, in addition to protest and CSR, various social improvement techniques are covered that are relevant to fairness and efficiency. During the lecture, four points of view about the production method are presented: 1. Utilitarian, which disregards the distribution of resources in favor of maximizing the aggregate utility of all individuals. This theory aims to produce a Pareto optimal solution. While in my opinion, public welfare should be taken into account when determining the living quality of people rather than just considering the wealthiest minority. As a result, this theory's flaw is that it doesn't give consideration to justice. 2. Libertarian, believes the final consequences of the market are the best, while the current existence of governments is the best rebuttal for this theory. Problems of free-riding and monopoly would occur frequently without government intervention. 3. Egalitarian, in which fairness is strictly concerned. According to this theory, each person should receive approximately the same allocation of resources.

However, the incentive to work will be low in this case, which causes the efficiency of production under the instruction of this theory might be much lower than that of others, which causes the general living standards to be low. As a result, the 4th theory: The Rawlsian theory is better than the previous ones. An improvement could be achieved by addressing the issue of poverty and providing aid to the underprivileged. This idea achieves a reasonable balance between the demands of fairness and efficiency.

In conclusion, in this portfolio, I have discussed the many exploitation types and provided my personal viewpoint. The issue of child labor should be addressed not only by raising the standard of education but also by encouraging parents to let their kids attend school. Pornography is harmful because it sends the notion that women should be objectified. The family strategy and opportunity cost should be used to determine who works at home, not the person's gender. Because modern slavery frequently involves the exploitation of freedom, it is harmful. Apart from that, protests, CSR, and economic theory on production are other examples of social improvement methods I have discussed in lectures. I have also provided justifications for some theories covered and presented my own opinions.

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